of the Constitution of India. Articles 124 to 147 of the Constitution lays down the composition and jurisdiction of the Supreme Court of India. Originally the Constitution provided for the chief Justice and seven lower ranking Judges. The Constitution enables the Parliament to increase this number. By 2008, the number of judge have been increased from eight to 30. By 2019, there are 34 judges including chief justice.

As to the appointment of the Supreme Court judges, The Chief Justice of India should consult a "Collegium" of four senior most judges of the Supreme Court. The Collegium makes the decision in consensus. Every Judge of the Supreme Court is appointed by the President after consultation with the cabinet and the Judges of the Supreme Court and such Judges shall hold office until they attain the age of sixty five years. If any of the judges wants to lay down office, he can do so through an hand written signed resignation letter to the President; the Parliament can remove a Judge through an impeachment. To be considered for the office of Judge, one must be a citizen of India and his qualification is per the Parliament's decision, and the should have been judge of High Court at least for a period of 5 years; or an advocates of a High Court or of two or more such courts in succession for at least 10 years or the person must be, in the opinion of the President, a distinguished jurist.

Impeachment

A Judge of the Supreme Court can be tried by an order of the President, after an address by each House of the Parliament supported by a majority of the total membership of that house and by a majority of not less than two thirds of the members of the house present and voting in the same session.

Appointments are generally made on the basis of Seniority



In 2007, Justice K.G. Balakrishnan became the first Chief Justice of the Supreme Court from the scheduled caste community.

The Supreme Court of India under the present Constitution commenced functioning on January 28, 1950. It was placed then in the Chamber of Princes in the Parliament. It moved to the present building in 1958.



Harilal J. Kania was the first Chief Justice of the Supreme Court. The other judges who assumed office along with him wise Justices Sayid Faze Ali, M. Patanjali Sastri, Mehar Chand Mahajan, Bijan Kumar, Mukherjea and S.R.Das.

High Courts

The High Court is the head of a State's judicial administration and every constituent state in expected to have a High Court. However, at present, four High Courts have jurisdiction over more than one state. Among the Union Territories, Delhi alone has a High Court of its own. Other six Union Territories come under the

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